

company—at an average annual percentage rate of 16 percent—which you need to help you stay afloat.

It's hard to know how many people choose this lifestyle consciously, but regardless, it is the norm for most Americans. Most gradually slide further into a hole that keeps them trapped on this standard path.

Similarly, most people say relationships and family are the most important things in their lives, but a job is where they spend the majority of their time and energy. Why do people stay in lifestyles so out of alignment with their stated values?

Those who want something better and are good savers go to financial advisors because we've heard how complicated investing is. We pay excessive fees and taxes following the usual advice that keeps us trapped on the standard path. Most advisors receive commissions for the sale of financial products or are paid as a percentage of the assets you have invested with them. This incentivizes the financial industry to unnecessarily complicate investing, so clients remain dependent on them. It's also in their best interest for clients to always strive for more rather than determine how much is "enough."